Class 22 Reading Homework

Era 8: Westward Expansion · Focus: Mexican-American War · Gold Rush · Wilmot Proviso

Reading due today: AMSCO 5.3

Connect: The Wilmot Proviso reopens the exact question the Missouri Compromise (Class 13) tried to close. Why couldn't the 1820 solution work in 1846?

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **5.3 (LO C):** Explain the causes and effects of the Mexican–American War.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

[ ] Mexican Cession
[ ] Wilmot Proviso

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

[ ] J.K. Polk
[ ] Z. Taylor
[ ] W. Scott

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

[ ] Mexican-American War (1846–48)
[ ] Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo (1848)
[ ] Gold Rush (1849)

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Why did Polk provoke war with Mexico, and what territory did the U.S. gain in the Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo?

2. What did the Wilmot Proviso propose, and why did it fail in the Senate?

3. Was the Wilmot Proviso mainly an antislavery measure, a way to protect free white labor in the West, or both? Defend your answer.